define it: 'If I were asked to define the Hindu creed, I should simply say: Search after truth through nonviolent means. A man may not believe in God and still call himself a Hindu. Hinduism is a relentless pursuit after truth. .. Hinduism is the religion of truth. T r u t h is God. Denial of God we have known. Denial of truth we have not known.' T r u t h and non-violence, so says G a n d h i : but many eminent and undoubted Hindus say that non-violence, as Gandhi understands it, is 110 essential part of the Hindu creed. We thus have truth left by itself as the distinguishing mark of Hinduism. T h a t , of course, is no definition at all.

It is, therefore, incorrect and undesirable to use ' H i n d u ' or 'Hinduism' for Indian culture, even with reference to the distant past, although the various aspects of thought, as embodied in ancient writings, were the dominant expression of that culture. Much more is it incorrect to use those terms, in that sense, today. So long as the old faith and philosophy were chiefly a way of life and an outlook on the world, they were largely synonymous with Indian culture; but when a more rigid religion developed, with all manner of ritual and ceremonial, it became something more and at the same time something much less than that compo-